

ACTIVITY 1

LEVELS:

Grade 12, University Preparation

COURSES:

Canada and World Issues
GC1.01, HEV.01, HE1.03

TASK:

Through a simulation exercise,
students communicate their
values related to the earth.

EXPECTATIONS:

The student will:

- Identify approaches relating to the protection and sustainability of the planet's life-support systems.
- Identify the complex nature of the earth's natural systems
- Understand the interdependence of the earth and the natural environment.

TIMEFRAME:

20 Minutes

ACHIEVEMENT CATEGORIES:

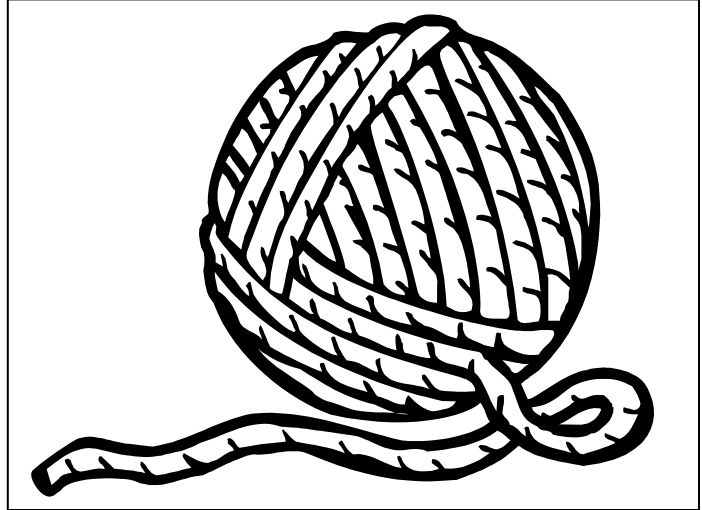
Thinking / Inquiry
Communication

MATERIALS:

Ball of yarn

VOCABULARY:

Interdependence
Ecosystems



Yarn of Life

PROCEDURE

1. Students take a piece of paper and jot down what they value most about the earth. Beside each of these values, students jot down things that might threaten or are threatening their values about the earth. Before joining the whole class in a circle, students must select one of the values as a priority for them. At the end of the module, in Unit 3, students will return to these values and identify one action they can take to reduce the threat that affects what they value most about the earth.
2. Have the class stand in a circle.
3. The first person with the ball of yarn holds one end of the yarn and throws the ball to someone else.
4. While holding the ball, they say what they value about the earth and identify the threat. (Example: I value clean air; Emissions from vehicles and factories are a threat to clean air.)
5. At the end, the web that is created symbolizes life that is earth and that all of the natural environment is interconnected.
6. Have the students discuss some of the connections between their values and how they interact. For example, if one student values the sun and one, water, they may identify that the sun heats the surface of the water so the various water species can survive.⁶

⁶ Adapted from Ten Days for Global Justice 2000-01 Education and Action Guide.